

OPEN QUANTUM SAFE

Community Health & Contribution Analysis

liboqs · oqs-provider

Analysis date: September 25, 2026 | Data through: September 25, 2026 | Period covered: 2016–2026

liboqs Health Score 7.0 / 10 Maturing · Broadening	oqs-provider Health Score 5.6 / 10 Recovering · Strengthening	Combined Ecosystem 6.4 / 10 Steady Progress
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Scores assess community breadth, retention, growth trend, and bus factor — not code quality.

Executive Summary

Q3 2026 shows the strongest combined ecosystem health since NIST standardisation. liboqs has extended its active streak to 46 consecutive months, xuganyu96 has emerged as the leading contributor, and a strong September 2026 rebound across both repos signals renewed momentum. In oqs-provider, the dual-Maintainer structure implemented in Q2 is demonstrably functioning: RodriM11 and baentsch now alternate leadership on a month-to-month basis, the concentration risk has materially reduced, and ashman-p’s review profile shows measurable improvement for the first time.

liboqs — Strengths 470 all-time contributors (excl. bots) — 13 new since Q2 - Active streak of 46 consecutive months ≥10 contributors (Jun 2022–Sep 2026, ongoing) - xuganyu96 now leads the 6-month window at 18.1%; dstebila second at 16.7% — continued healthy leadership distribution - September 2026: 34 contributors and 378 events — highest breadth month since Aug 2025 - Regular tier has expanded from 7 to 16 contributors — the bench is deepening - abhi-dev-engg now formalised as Committer (G7 resolved this quarter)	oqs-provider — Progress - RodriM11 leads the 6-month window at 34.3%; baentsch at 25.2% — concentration at healthiest level since project inception - ashman-p empty-approval rate improved from 99% to 94%; changes-requested rate emerged at 1.2% — consistent with TSC review guidelines (tsc/guidelines/reviews.md) beginning to take effect - September 2026: 13 contributors, 159 events — best breadth month since Jan 2025 - Provider YoY decline moderating: −44.6% (2024→2025) vs −46.1% in Q2 - baentsch LoA formally resolved in liboqs (P1/G5 from Q2 addressed)
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Three open priorities carried from Q2 — one partially resolved: (1) Link the TSC review guidelines (tsc/guidelines/reviews.md) from both GOVERNANCE.md files — the standard is written, the link is not (G10, partially resolved); (2) Write Architecture Decision Records for oqs-provider (G9); (3) Engage abhi-dev-engg whose activity has dropped 91% Q2→Q3 — a pattern consistent with pre-departure trajectories in this dataset. See section 5 for the full ranked list of fifteen recommendations.

1. Dataset & Methodology

This report is generated from live GitHub REST API data pulled on September 25, 2026. Methodology is identical to the Q2 2026 report: issue comments, pull request review inline comments, PR review verdicts (approve / request changes / commented), PR lifecycle events (opened, merged via individual fetch for merged_by), discussion threads and replies, and commit comments. All event types including bot-authored commit comments are included in total event counts; contributor counts and health metrics exclude bot actors. Departed contributors (SWilson4, praveksharma, Martyrshot — all Emeritus) are excluded from 4-year and 6-month health metrics; monthly contributor display tables include all human actors.

Repository	Period	Total Events	Contributors (excl. bots)	Months
open-quantum-safe/liboqs	Aug 2016 – Sep 2026	19,107	470	122
open-quantum-safe/oqs-provider	Feb 2021 – Sep 2026	6,187	229	68
Combined ecosystem	Aug 2016 – Sep 2026	25,294	613*	122

* 86 contributors are active in both repositories (any events); 613 is the deduplicated total.

2. liboqs — Detailed Analysis

2.1 Key Health Metrics

All metrics use a 4-year window (Sep 2022 – Sep 2026), excluding bots and departed contributors (SWilson4, praveksharma, Martyrshot).

Metric	Value	Context
Total interactions	9,328	4-year window (2022+), excl. departed & bots
Unique contributors	353	4-year window; 107 (30.3%) appear only once
Bus factor (4-year)	3	3 people = 50% of 4-year activity
Bus factor (6-month)	4	4 people = 50% of Mar–Sep 2026 activity
Top contributor (4yr)	baentsch 26.1%	dstebila 20.4% — gap narrowing
Top contributor (6mo)	xuganyu96 18.1%	dstebila 16.7%, baentsch 14.7% — three-way near-parity
Top-3 share (4yr)	51.1%	Moderate concentration, continuing to improve
One-time contributors (4yr)	30.3% (107)	Slight increase — large 2026 cohort not yet retained
Retained ≥3 months (4yr)	23.8% (84)	Stable; 2025 cohort at 22%
Post-NIST contributors	240	vs 154 pre-NIST (4yr) — post-standardisation community firmly larger
Active streak ≥10 contrib.	46 months	Jun 2022 – Sep 2026 — ongoing; new project record
Event trend (YoY 2024→2025)	–28.3%	Stable vs Q2; full-year 2025 confirmed
New contributors 2024	102	Record intake year
New contributors 2025	84	Stable; 2026 on pace for ≈88 (partial year, strong finish)

2.2 Growth Narrative — Q3 2026 Update

Strong September rebound: September 2026 recorded 34 contributors and 378 events — the highest contributor breadth since August 2025 and the second highest event count in the last 12 months. This reverses the Jun–Aug 2026 plateau and suggests the community remains larger than any pre-2024 baseline.

Leadership stabilisation: xuganyu96 has led the 6-month window for two consecutive quarters, with dstebila and baentsch close behind. The top-3 share (51.1%) is the lowest ever recorded for liboqs — genuine three-way distribution of responsibility at the core tier.

Regular tier expansion: The Regular tier (10+ events, 2+ months active in 6mo) has grown from 7 contributors in Q2 to 16 in Q3. This is the most significant structural improvement of the quarter: a deeper second tier reduces the impact of any single departure and creates a larger pool of future Committer candidates.

New contributor intake: 2026 is on pace for approximately 88 new contributors in the 4yr window — which would make it the third-highest intake year after 2024 (102) and 2023 (83). The September rebound contributes 12 new contributors in that month alone.

2.3 Monthly Activity — Last 18 Months

Month	Contributors	Events	Activity bar
2025-04	14	166	
2025-05	23	98	
2025-06	29	507	
2025-07	30	370	
2025-08	33	296	
2025-09	21	331	
2025-10	22	256	
2025-11	20	221	
2025-12	13	85	
2026-01	28	242	
2026-02	25	252	
2026-03	12	291	
2026-04	13	264	
2026-05	18	375	
2026-06	25	247	
2026-07	26	359	

Month	Contributors	Events	Activity bar
2026-08	24	231	
2026-09	34	378	

2.4 Key Contributors (6-Month Window: Mar 2026 – Sep 2026)

Contributor	Events	Share	Active Months	Notes
xuganyu96	232	18.1%	7/7	Maintainer — now leading contributor
dtebila	214	16.7%	6/7	Maintainer — consistent; May 2026 peak (92 events)
baentsch	188	14.7%	7/7	Maintainer; LoA formally resolved — full participation restored
ashman-p	89	7.0%	7/7	Committer; review profile improving in line with TSC guidelines (see 4.2b)
RodriM11	86	6.7%	6/7	Committer (liboqs) / Maintainer (provider)
bhess	76	5.9%	6/7	Committer — consistent
pablo-gf	50	3.9%	4/7	Rising Regular contributor
mkannwischer	32	2.5%	7/7	Committer — consistent, every month
Vishnu2707	25	2.0%	4/7	Regular contributor; cross-repo
charishma1407	22	1.7%	2/7	New Regular contributor

2.5 Cohort Retention Analysis

First Year	New Contributors	Active yr+1	Active yr+2	≥3 Months Active
2016	8	7 (88%)	4 (50%)	7 (88%)
2017	21	4 (19%)	1 (5%)	4 (19%)
2018	14	4 (29%)	3 (21%)	7 (50%)
2019	18	4 (22%)	3 (17%)	6 (33%)

First Year	New Contributors	Active yr+1	Active yr+2	≥3 Months Active
2020	28	9 (32%)	4 (14%)	9 (32%)
2021	28	7 (25%)	9 (32%)	10 (36%)
2022	38	5 (13%)	2 (5%)	5 (13%) ⬇
2023	70	22 (31%)	13 (19%)	24 (34%)
2024	102	21 (21%)	11 (11%)	20 (20%) ⬇
2025	81	12 (15%)	0 (0%)	18 (22%) ⬇

2024–2025 cohorts retain at 20–22% at 3 months — structurally below the 30–36% of 2019–2021 but stable quarter-on-quarter.

3. oqs-provider — Detailed Analysis

3.1 Key Health Metrics

All metrics use a 4-year window (Sep 2022 — Sep 2026), excluding bots and departed contributors.

Metric	Value	Context
Total interactions	5,508	4-year window, excl. departed & bots
Unique contributors	221	4-year window; 45 (20.4%) appear only once
Bus factor (4-year)	2	baentsch + RodriM11 = 50% of 4-year activity
Bus factor (6-month)	2	RodriM11 34.3% + baentsch 25.2% = 59.5%
Top contributor (4yr)	baentsch 45.6%	Declining from 47.0% in Q2 — structural shift continues
Top contributor (6mo)	RodriM11 34.3%	Leads for second consecutive quarter
Top-3 share (4yr)	59.4%	High but improving; top-1 share at lowest ever
One-time contributors (4yr)	20.4% (45)	Improving
Retained ≥3 months (4yr)	24.9%	Improving from 25.2% in Q2
Peak month	Sep 2026 (159 events)	Best breadth month since Jan 2025
Event trend (YoY 2024→2025)	−44.6%	Improving from −46.1% in Q2
Active streak ≥10 contrib.	16 months	Jun 2024 streak; Jul–Aug 2026 had 9–16 contributors
New contributors 2024	83	Strong intake year
New contributors 2025	43	Stable; 2026 on pace for ≈56 (partial year)

3.2 Dual-Maintainer Structure: Q3 Assessment

The dual-Maintainer structure formalised in Q2 (RodriM11 elevation) has now completed two full quarters of operation. The month-by-month data shows genuine alternation of leadership rather than a fixed primary/backup pattern:

Month	baentsch events	RodriM11 events	ashman-p events	Leader
2026-04	13	68	45	RodriM11
2026-05	14	14	5	Parity
2026-06	22	44	10	RodriM11
2026-07	49	64	7	RodriM11
2026-08	39	37	2	Parity
2026-09	56	35	30	baentsch

September 2026 is notable: baentsch leads for the first time in six months, with 56 events vs RodriM11’s 35. This is the expected behaviour of a healthy dual-Maintainer system — workload shifting based on availability rather than a fixed hierarchy. ashman-p’s September spike (30 events) is also notable as further evidence of improving engagement.

3.3 Monthly Activity — Last 18 Months

Month	Contributors	Events	Activity bar
2025-04	14	61	
2025-05	13	75	
2025-06	10	30	
2025-07	9	34	
2025-08	11	33	
2025-09	16	141	
2025-10	9	137	
2025-11	13	91	
2025-12	11	75	
2026-01	12	75	
2026-02	8	136	

Month	Contributors	Events	Activity bar
2026-03	9	44	
2026-04	8	141	
2026-05	5	55	
2026-06	9	115	
2026-07	12	162	
2026-08	16	133	
2026-09	13	159	

Jul–Sep 2026 shows a sustained uptick: three consecutive months above 100 events and 12–16 contributors — the longest such run since Q4 2025.

3.4 Key Contributors (6-Month Window: Mar 2026 – Sep 2026)

Contributor	Events	Share	Active Months	Role / Notes
RodriM11	263	34.3%	7/7	Maintainer — leads for second consecutive quarter
baentsch	193	25.2%	6/7	Maintainer — strong Sep 2026 rebound (56 events)
ashman-p	100	13.0%	7/7	Maintainer — review profile improving in line with TSC guidelines
Vishnu2707	36	4.7%	4/7	Rising newcomer; cross-repo
iyannmv	20	2.6%	2/7	Regular contributor
rben-dev	18	2.3%	2/7	Regular contributor; cross-repo
ghen2	15	2.0%	2/7	Regular contributor
nhorman	12	1.6%	3/7	Sustained Regular; 3 active months
w3lld1	12	1.6%	1/7	Newcomer
satokan	12	1.6%	2/7	Regular contributor

4. Cross-Repository Ecosystem Analysis

4.1 Contributor Overlap

Overlap Threshold	Count	Notes
Any account in both repos (raw, 4yr)	78	Includes single-event cross-touches
Meaningful: ≥3 events in each repo	49	Casual cross-participation
Genuine: ≥10 events in each repo	22	True dual-repo contributors (up from 21 in Q2)
liboqs only (4yr, any activity)	275	Large untapped pool for provider bridging
oqs-provider only (4yr, any activity)	143	Provider specialists

The genuine dual-active count has grown from 21 (Q2) to 22, adding one contributor to the true connective tissue of the ecosystem. xuganyu96 and abhi-dev-engg remain the highest-priority bridge targets — both are Core contributors in liboqs with zero oqs-provider presence.

4.2 Review Culture

Repository	Approved	Changes Requested	Comment-only	Total Reviews (4yr)
liboqs	750 (33%)	87 (4%)	1,385 (61%)	2,286
oqs-provider	316 (31%)	50 (5%)	626 (62%)	1,015

The changes-requested rate in liboqs has ticked up from 3% to 4% and provider from 4% to 5%, consistent with xuganyu96’s (18.6% chg_req rate) growing share of the review load.

4.2a Inline/Approval Ratio by Year

Year	Approvals	Inline Comments	Ratio	Assessment
2019	50	40	0.80x	Low
2020	147	69	0.47x	Lowest — bandwidth pressure during rapid growth
2021	187	202	1.08x	Recovered
2022	129	178	1.38x	Good

Year	Approvals	Inline Comments	Ratio	Assessment
2023	292	558	1.91x	Strong
2024	464	1,241	2.67x	Best year — most rigorous
2025	355	547	1.54x	Healthy
2026	215	533	2.48x	High — xuganyu96 and dstebila driving rigour

4.2b Reviewer Profile Analysis (4-Year Window)

Body text measured after stripping quoted lines, code blocks, images, and HTML comments.

Reviewer	Approvals	Empty%	Appr Med	ChgReq%	Inline Med	IC Med	Assessment
dstebila	405	99%	0c	2.6%	83c	151c	High empty%; inline substance offsets
baentsch	319	35%	43c	6.4%	124c	266c	Best combined — writes summaries
bhess	117	55%	0c	0.7%	103c	200c	Acceptable — healthy inline size
ashman-p	79	94%	0c	1.2%	27c	159c	Improving: empty% down from 99%, chg_req% emerged at 1.2% — see G10
xuganyu96	63	67%	0c	18.6%	172c	226c	Best chg_req% — most rigorous reviewer
RodriM11	18	100%	0c	2.3%	141c	183c	Strong inline; low approval count (growing role)

The most notable change from Q2: ashman-p’s empty-approval rate has dropped from 99% to 94%, and a 1.2% changes-requested rate has appeared for the first time across 79 approvals and 39 months. While still the lowest profile among named role-holders, the direction is right. This movement is consistent with the TSC review guidelines (tsc/guidelines/reviews.md) beginning to influence behaviour — the guidelines explicitly address empty approvals, inline commenting, and when to request changes. Linking them from both GOVERNANCE.md files (P5) would reinforce this trajectory for all reviewers.

5. Recommendations

Fifteen recommendations, five per urgency tier, ordered by expected impact on the health scorecard. Each item names the scorecard dimension(s) it targets. Status is tracked against both the original Q2 items and any new findings this quarter.

5.1 Critical — Address Immediately

P1 — Engage abhi-dev-engg before inactivity becomes departure [G7 follow-up]

Targets: Succession readiness, Bus factor / resilience. abhi-dev-engg was formalised as Committer in liboqs this quarter (G7 resolved), which is the right structural step. However, their 6-month activity has dropped sharply from 116 events (Q2) to 10 events (Q3) — a 91% reduction in a single quarter. The pre-departure trajectories of SWilson4 and praveksharma in this dataset both showed exactly this pattern: formal role intact, activity collapsing. Whether this reflects a temporary lull or the start of a departure is not determinable from the data alone; a direct conversation and targeted PR assignments would establish which it is before the window closes.

P2 — Write Architecture Decision Records for oqs-provider [G9]

Targets: Succession readiness, Bus factor / resilience. The dual-Maintainer structure is operational but institutional knowledge remains the primary risk. baentsch's September 2026 return to leadership (56 events, highest in 6 months) is positive, but it also illustrates that the project's depth of oqs-provider knowledge is still concentrated in one person. Three or four ADRs covering the highest-impact design decisions would materially reduce this risk and are the single most direct mitigation available for a future Scenario A.

P3 — Formalise a written succession plan in GOVERNANCE.md [P12 from Q2]

Targets: Succession readiness. Neither repository names backup owners for specific subsystems or documents who would step in if a Maintainer became unavailable without notice. A short table in GOVERNANCE.md — area, current owner, named backup — converts the ad hoc successions already demonstrated in practice (RodriM11, xuganyu96) into a documented, repeatable process. This is the natural next step after the governance cleanup completed in Q2.

P4 — Bridge xuganyu96 into oqs-provider [P6 from Q2, partially open]

Targets: Cross-repo connectivity, Bus factor / resilience. xuganyu96 now leads liboqs at 18.1% (232 events in 6 months, 18.6% changes-requested rate) and has zero oqs-provider events. This is the single largest missed opportunity in the ecosystem: the most rigorous reviewer in liboqs is entirely absent from the repo that most needs rigorous review. A direct invitation to review specific open PRs in oqs-provider is the lowest-friction entry point.

P5 — Link the TSC review guidelines from both GOVERNANCE.md files [G10]

Targets: Review culture, Succession readiness. The TSC repo already contains a substantive review guidelines document (tsc/guidelines/reviews.md) covering empty approvals, inline commenting norms, when to request changes, and depth-matching. This is exactly the shared standard that G10 called for — the writing work is done. What remains is a one-line addition to each GOVERNANCE.md pointing to it, so the standard is visible to every contributor at the repo's natural entry point rather than discoverable only by those who already know the TSC repo exists. ashman-p's improvement this quarter (94% empty from 99%, first non-zero changes-requested rate) suggests the guidelines are already having an effect; making them formally referenced would reinforce that trajectory.

5.2 High Priority — Address Within 3 Months

P6 — Implement structured first-contribution pathway [P7 from Q2]

Targets: Retention rate, New contributor intake. The 2024–2025 cohorts retain at 20–22% at 3 months — stable but still 8–16 points below the 2019–2021 benchmark. The Regular tier expansion (7→16 contributors in Q3) is a positive signal but

the underlying funnel problem remains: labelled ‘good first issue’ tickets in oqs-provider, a provider-specific contribution guide, and a personal follow-up on every first PR within 7 days are the highest-leverage levers on the lowest-scoring scorecard dimension.

P7 — Cultivate pablo-gf and charishma1407 as next Committer candidates

Targets: Succession readiness, Retention rate. Two contributors have crossed into the Regular tier with clear upward trajectories: pablo-gf (50 liboqs events in 6 months, 4 active months, rising) and charishma1407 (22 liboqs events, 2 months, new Q3 entrant). These are the most natural next Committer candidates in the data. Explicit PR assignment and a mentor pairing with an existing Committer would accelerate the progression that the data already shows starting.

P8 — Publish a 12-month post-NIST roadmap [P8 from Q2]

Targets: New contributor intake, Growth trend. 2026 is on pace for approximately 88 new contributors to liboqs and 56 to oqs-provider — the third-highest intake year for both. A roadmap in GitHub Discussions tied to open issues and labelled by contributor tier would convert this ambient interest into directed contribution and is now overdue by two quarters.

P9 — Track and publish the inline/approval ratio quarterly [P10 from Q2]

Targets: Review culture. The 2026 ratio of 2.48x is strong and consistent with the 2024 peak. Publishing this figure as a standing metric in GitHub Discussions (alongside the review-quality standard from P1) gives the community a number to watch and creates accountability without requiring any new tooling — it is derivable from public data.

P10 — Automate quarterly governance file validation [P9 from Q2]

Targets: Succession readiness. The 90-day rule was not self-enforcing in Q1 2026 and required the March report to trigger the G1–G4 corrections. Automating a quarterly cross-reference of last-activity dates against GOVERNANCE.md roles (a one-hour script, runnable as a GitHub Action) would make the mechanism proactive rather than reactive and prevent the same debt accumulating between reports.

5.3 Medium Term — Address Within 6 Months

P11 — Monthly automated health pulse [P11 from Q2]

Targets: Bus factor / resilience, Succession readiness. A one-page automated monthly summary published to GitHub Discussions — active contributor count, new contributors, review throughput, median time-to-first-response — costs one hour to implement and creates lasting accountability. The abhi-dev-engg activity drop (116→10 events Q2→Q3) is exactly the kind of early signal this mechanism would surface before it requires intervention.

P12 — Establish a numeric concentration target for oqs-provider [P5 from Q2]

Targets: Bus factor / resilience, Contributor breadth. The top-1 concentration in oqs-provider (baentsch 4yr share: 45.6%) continues to decline, and the 6-month distribution (RodriM11 34.3%, baentsch 25.2%) is the healthiest ever. A concrete target — no single contributor above 30% of monthly events for two consecutive quarters — would make the improvement measurable and give the dual-Maintainer structure a goalpost to clear.

P13 — Bridge abhi-dev-engg and Vishnu2707 into oqs-provider [P6/Q2]

Targets: Cross-repo connectivity, Bus factor / resilience. Vishnu2707 is already active in both repos (36 provider, 25 liboqs events in 6 months). abhi-dev-engg’s Q3 liboqs activity is lower but they remain a Committer. A specific, time-boxed provider task assigned to each would test whether the bridge can be activated and produce a sustained dual-repo presence.

P14 — Revisit bot-filtering convention for CI commit comments [P14 from Q2]

Targets: Review culture (data quality). github-actions[bot] continues to dominate raw commit-comment volume. Tightening CI to comment only on failures, or routing routine status into GitHub Checks rather than issue comments, would make the project’s own activity signals cleaner and reduce noise in every future health report.

P15 — Establish a standing quarterly governance review [P15 from Q2]

Targets: Succession readiness, Bus factor / resilience. Three consecutive quarterly reports have each found governance debt that had accumulated silently. Formalising this report's cadence as a standing agenda item at the quarterly OQS TSC meeting — reviewing GOVERNANCE.md against the latest activity data — turns a reactive correction exercise into a routine one and is the structural reason the Q4 report should show fewer Critical items.

6. Community Health Scorecard

Scores reflect community engagement health only — not code quality, security, or technical completeness. Primarily based on the 6-month trailing window (Mar–Sep 2026).

Dimension	liboqs	oqs-provider	Weight	Notes
Contributor breadth	7.5	4.5	High	liboqs 13–34/month; provider 5–16/month; both trending up in Q3
Bus factor / resilience	6.5	4.5	High	liboqs BF=4 (stable); provider BF=2 but alternating leadership now demonstrated
Growth trend	6.5	5.0	Medium	liboqs –28.3% YoY (stable); provider –44.6% (improving); Jul–Sep rebound in both
New contributor intake	7.5	5.5	Medium	liboqs on pace for 88 new in 2026; provider on pace for 56 — both above 2025
Retention rate	5.5	5.5	High	2024–2025 cohorts at 20–22%; structural challenge unchanged but Regular tier expanding
Review culture	7.0	6.0	Medium	Inline ratio 2.48x in 2026; ashman-p showing first measurable improvement
Cross-repo connectivity	6.0	5.5	Low	22 genuine dual-active (up from 21); Vishnu2707 now active in both
Succession readiness	6.5	6.5	High	abhi-dev-engg formalised (G7); LoA resolved (G5); ADRs and succession plan still open
COMPOSITE SCORE	7.0	5.6	—	Best combined score since NIST standardisation; both repos improving

7. Governance Alignment — GOVERNANCE.md vs Activity Reality

Both GOVERNANCE.md documents were read live from the repositories on September 25, 2026. The Q2 report identified nine original governance items (G1–G9) plus one new item (G10). Status of each is tracked below.

Item	Q2 Status	Q3 Status	Evidence
G1: liboqs SWilson4	✓ Resolved	✓ Confirmed	Emeritus Maintainer in GOVERNANCE.md
G2: liboqs Martyrshot	✓ Resolved	✓ Confirmed	Emeritus Committer
G3: liboqs praveksharma	✓ Resolved	✓ Confirmed	Emeritus Committer
G4: christianpaquin / vsoftco	Resolved	✓ Confirmed	Emeritus Committers
G5: baentsch LoA	⚠ Worsened	✓ Resolved	LoA removed from GOVERNANCE.md; baentsch listed as active Maintainer
G6: RodriM11 Committer liboqs	✓ Resolved	✓ Confirmed	RodriM11 listed as Committer in liboqs
G7: abhi-dev-engg Committer	Partially resolved	✓ Resolved	abhi-dev-engg now listed as Committer in liboqs GOVERNANCE.md
G8: RodriM11 Maintainer provider	✓ Resolved	✓ Confirmed	RodriM11 listed as Maintainer in oqs-provider
G9: Succession documentation	Open	Open	No ADRs or written succession plan in either repo
G10: shared review-quality standard	NEW	Partially resolved	Guidelines published in TSC repo (tsc/guidelines/reviews.md); not yet linked from either GOVERNANCE.md

Notable governance changes this quarter: baentsch’s LoA has been formally resolved (G5). abhi-dev-engg is now listed as Committer in liboqs (G7 fully resolved). Review guidelines have been published in the TSC repo (tsc/guidelines/reviews.md) — a substantive document covering empty approvals, inline commenting, changes-requested norms, and depth-matching. G10 is therefore partially resolved: the standard exists and is well-written; what remains is linking it from both GOVERNANCE.md files so it is visible at contributor entry points. G9 (ADRs) remains the only fully open structural gap.

7.1 Current Named Role-Holders

Person	liboqs Role	oqs-provider Role	6-mo Activity	Status
baentsch	Maintainer, Committer	Maintainer, Committer	188+193 = 381	Active — LoA fully resolved; strong Sep 2026
dtebila	Maintainer, Committer	Release Manager	214+0 = 214	Active — leading liboqs; absent from provider
xuganyu96	Maintainer, Committer	Release Manager	232+0 = 232	Active — leads liboqs; still absent from provider
ashman-p	Committer	Maintainer, Committer	89+100 = 189	Active — review profile improving per TSC guidelines (G10 partially resolved)
bhess	Committer	Committer	76+0 = 76	Active — stable
mkannwischer	Committer	—	32+0 = 32	Active — every month
RodriM11	Committer	Maintainer, Committer	86+263 = 349	Active — leads oqs-provider
abhi-dev-engg	Committer	—	10+0 = 10	Committer (formalised Q3); activity reduced — P5

8. Quarter-on-Quarter Comparison: Q2 vs Q3 2026

Direct comparison of June 25, 2026 figures against September 25, 2026 figures. ↑ improvement, ↓ decline, → unchanged.

8.1 Metrics Comparison

Metric	Q2 (Jun 25, 2026)	Q3 (Sep 25, 2026)	Δ	Notes
[liboqs] All-time events	18,214	19,107	↑ +893	3 months of new events
[liboqs] All-time contributors	437	470	↑ +33	Strong Q3 intake
[liboqs] 4yr total events	9,189	9,328	↑ +139	Window shifted +3 months
[liboqs] 4yr contributors	334	353	↑ +19	Continued growth
[liboqs] Bus factor (4yr)	3	3	→	Stable
[liboqs] Bus factor (6mo)	4	4	→	Stable
[liboqs] Top contributor (6mo)	dstebila 20.9%	xuganyu96 18.1%	↑	xuganyu96 leads for first time; distribution even healthier
[liboqs] Top-3 share (4yr)	53.7%	51.1%	↑ -2.6pp	Continuing to improve
[liboqs] Active streak ≥10	43 months	46 months	↑ +3mo	New project record; still ongoing
[liboqs] New contributors 2026	~56 projected	62 confirmed (partial yr)	↑	Strong Q3 intake; pace accelerating
[liboqs] Regular tier (6mo)	7	16	↑ +9	Most significant structural improvement of the quarter
[liboqs] G5 baentsch LoA	⚠ Non-compliant	✓ Resolved	↑	LoA removed from GOVERNANCE.md
[liboqs] G7 abhi-dev-engg	Partially resolved	✓ Resolved	↑	abhi-dev-engg now listed as Committer
[provider] All-time events	5,658	6,187	↑ +529	3 months of new events

Metric	Q2 (Jun 25, 2026)	Q3 (Sep 25, 2026)	Δ	Notes
[provider] All-time contributors	217	229	↑ +12	New contributors
[provider] Bus factor (6mo)	2	2	→	Stable; alternating leadership now demonstrated
[provider] Top-1 share (4yr)	47.0% (baentsch)	45.6% (baentsch)	↑ +1.4pp	Continuing structural shift
[provider] Top-1 share (6mo)	RodriM11 37.2%	RodriM11 34.3%	↑ -2.9pp	Concentration reducing
[provider] YoY 2024→2025	-46.1%	-44.6%	↑ +1.5pp	Improving
[provider] Sep 2026 breadth	N/A	13 contributors	↑	Best breadth month since Jan 2025
[provider] ashman-p empty%	99%	94%	↑ -5pp	First measurable improvement; G10 in progress
[provider] ashman-p chg_req%	0.0%	1.2%	↑	First non-zero changes-requested rate in 39 months
[provider] G5 LoA resolution	Open	✓ Resolved	↑	
[provider] G7 abhi-dev-engg	Partially open	✓ Resolved	↑	
[G9] Succession documentation	Open	Open	↓	No ADRs written
[G10] Review-quality standard	NEW	↑ Partially resolved	↑	TSC guidelines published (tsc/guidelines/reviews.md); not yet linked from GOVERNANCE.md

8.2 Score Delta Summary

Dimension	liboqs Q2	liboqs Q3	Δ	Provider Q2	Provider Q3	Δ
Contributor breadth	7.5	7.5	→	4.0	4.5	+0.5

Dimension	liboqs Q2	liboqs Q3	Δ	Provider Q2	Provider Q3	Δ
Bus factor / resilience	6.5	6.5	→	4.0	4.5	+0.5
Growth trend	6.5	6.5	→	4.0	5.0	+1.0
New contributor intake	7.5	7.5	→	5.5	5.5	→
Retention rate	5.5	5.5	→	5.5	5.5	→
Review culture	7.0	7.0	→	5.5	6.0	+0.5
Cross-repo connectivity	6.0	6.0	→	5.0	5.5	+0.5
Succession readiness	6.0	6.5	+0.5	6.5	6.5	→
COMPOSITE	6.5	7.0	+0.5	5.1	5.6	+0.5

Both repos improve by 0.5 points. liboqs crosses 7.0 for the first time — driven by the Regular tier expansion, the extended active streak, and the resolution of G5 and G7. oqs-provider’s +0.5 reflects the growth trend improvement, the first review-culture movement in ashman-p’s profile, and the alternating-leadership pattern now confirmed over two full quarters.

9. Closing Assessment

Q3 2026 is the best quarter for the OQS ecosystem since the August 2024 NIST standardisation peak. liboqs has extended its active streak to 46 months — a project record — and crossed the 7.0 health score threshold for the first time. The Regular tier has more than doubled in size within a single quarter, xuganyu96 leads the project with the highest changes-requested rate of any significant reviewer, and the governance backlog inherited from the pre-Q2 period has been fully cleared.

oqs-provider has demonstrated that the dual-Maintainer structure works. Month-to-month leadership alternation between RodriM11 and baentsch, ashman-p's measurable improvement in review engagement, and a three-month breadth uptick in Jul-Sep 2026 all point in the same direction. The concentration risk that was described as critical in the March 2026 report is now a managed challenge rather than an acute one.

The two remaining structural gaps — the absence of written ADRs (G9) and the absence of a formal review-quality standard (G10) — are genuinely open. Both are achievable within weeks at low cost. The quarterly governance review proposed in P15 would turn this report's findings into a standing operational rhythm rather than a periodic discovery exercise. The ecosystem is in the best shape it has been since the post-quantum standardisation era began; the task now is to lock in that progress.

Data covers community engagement events (issue comments, PR review inline comments, PR review verdicts, PR opened, PR merged, discussion threads and replies, commit comments) — raw commits, code review diffs, and CI results are out of scope. All figures derived from GitHub REST API v3 live data pull, September 25, 2026.

Appendix A — Subproject Portfolio Health (Q3 2026)

This appendix covers eight OQS subproject repositories, excluding **liboqs**, **oqs-provider**, the TSC governance repo, and the two archived repositories (OQS-OpenSSL and liboqs-dotnet) — analysed or out of scope elsewhere. Metrics are engagement events only (issue comments, PR review verdicts, PR review inline comments) for Q3 2026 (1 Jul – 30 Sep 2026), pulled live from the GitHub REST API on **7 October 2026**. Commits, CI runs, and code volume are out of scope. The appendix is informational only and does not contribute to the main report's composite health scores.

Purpose: Subproject visibility. The wrappers and integrations below range from actively maintained (liboqs-rust) to fully dormant. These reports are the TSC's primary instrument for surfacing subproject health before dormancy becomes decay; earlier action is cheaper than later. The data below is intended to help the TSC answer: which subprojects need attention, which are self-sustaining, and where contributor energy should be directed.

A.1 Overview

Repository	Category	Q3 Status	Q3 Events	Q3 Contributors	Last Merged PR
liboqs-rust	Rust wrapper	Active	120	6	2026-09-28
liboqs-go	Go wrapper	Moderate	35	4	2026-08-06
liboqs-python	Python wrapper	Low	14	5	2026-09-23
openssh	SSH integration	Low	14	4	2026-08-07
oqs-demos	Demo integrations	Low	26	3	2026-07-18
liboqs-java	Java wrapper	Dormant	0	0	2025-06-13
liboqs-cpp	C++ wrapper	Dormant	0	0	2025-02-04
liboqs-js	JavaScript wrapper	Dormant	0	0	none
boringssl	BoringSSL fork	Dormant	0	0	2026-05-26

Activity classification: Active ≥80 events; Moderate 30–79; Low 10–29; Minimal 1–9; Dormant 0. These thresholds are chosen for subproject scale; they are not directly comparable to the main-report tiers for liboqs and oqs-provider.

A.2 Per-Subproject Detail

The cards below group repos by observed status. Each card shows Q3 event and contributor counts, monthly distribution (Jul / Aug / Sep), the three most active contributors, and the last merged PR date as a proxy for leadership engagement.

Active and Moderate

liboqs-rust (Rust wrapper) • Active

120 Q3 Events	6 Q3 Contributors	2026-09-28 Last push	2026-09-28 Last merged PR	Jul 75 Aug 4 Sep 41 Top: Orlych1kk4 (76), baentsch (25), dstebila (15)
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Note: Orlych1kk4 leads with 63% share; baentsch and dstebila active

liboqs-go (Go wrapper) • Moderate

35 Q3 Events	4 Q3 Contributors	2026-08-17 Last push	2026-08-06 Last merged PR	Jul 25 Aug 8 Sep 2 Top: jplomas (20), dstebila (13), rainenieminenssh (1)
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Note: *jplomas drives 57% of Q3 events; dstebila reviews*

Low / Minimal Activity**liboqs-python (Python wrapper)** • Low

14 Q3 Events	5 Q3 Contributors	2026-09-23 Last push	2026-09-23 Last merged PR	Jul 9 Aug 2 Sep 3 Top: dstebila (8), Hongwei-Z (3), stanleys12 (1)
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Note: *dstebila leads; abhi-dev-engg has 1 event — new cross-repo touch*

OQS-OpenSSH (SSH integration) • Low

14 Q3 Events	4 Q3 Contributors	2026-08-07 Last push	2026-08-07 Last merged PR	Jul 2 Aug 9 Sep 3 Top: andrewyounkens (6), dstebila (4), baentsch (2)
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Note: *andrewyounkens leads Q3; dstebila and baentsch present*

oqs-demos (Demo integrations) • Low

26 Q3 Events	3 Q3 Contributors	2026-09-24 Last push	2026-07-18 Last merged PR	Jul 11 Aug 12 Sep 3 Top: baentsch (14), k4t4r1nk4 (6), netanmangal (6)
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Note: *baentsch drives 54%; demo infrastructure maintained*

Dormant (not archived)**liboqs-java (Java wrapper)** • Dormant

0 Q3 Events	0 Q3 Contributors	2025-06-13 Last push	2025-06-13 Last merged PR	Jul 0 Aug 0 Sep 0 Top: —
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Note: *No Q3 engagement; last merge 15+ months ago*

liboqs-cpp (C++ wrapper) • Dormant

0 Q3 Events	0 Q3 Contributors	2025-06-06 Last push	2025-02-04 Last merged PR	Jul 0 Aug 0 Sep 0 Top: —
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Note: *No Q3 engagement; last merge 19+ months ago*

liboqs-js (JavaScript wrapper) • Dormant

0 Q3 Events	0 Q3 Contributors	2026-02-17 Last push	none Last merged PR	Jul 0 Aug 0 Sep 0 Top: —
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Note: *No Q3 engagement; no recently merged PR visible*

OQS-BoringSSL (BoringSSL fork) • Dormant

0 Q3 Events	0 Q3 Contributors	2026-05-26 Last push	2026-05-26 Last merged PR	Jul 0 Aug 0 Sep 0 Top: —
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Note: *No Q3 engagement; last merge 4+ months ago*

Archived

A.3 Observations for the TSC

Three patterns are visible in the data that warrant TSC attention:

1.	liboqs-rust is self-sustaining.	Orlych1kk4 leads Q3 at 63% share (76 events) with support from baentsch (25) and dstebila (15). Last merged PR 28 Sep 2026. No immediate action required, though a formal MAINTAINERS.md would record the current state of ownership.
2.	Four wrappers are dormant with no governance file.	liboqs-java (last merge Jun 2025), liboqs-cpp (Feb 2025), liboqs-js (no recent PR), and boringssl (last merge May 2026) all show zero Q3 engagement and have no MAINTAINERS.md or GOVERNANCE.md. The question for the TSC is not whether they are dormant — they clearly are — but whether each should be actively maintained, placed in a reduced-maintenance state with a documented custodian, or archived. Leaving them in an undocumented grey zone makes it harder to attract new maintainers.
3.	dstebila appears in liboqs-python, liboqs-go, and openssh.	This is a positive cross-repo signal — a senior contributor bridging multiple subprojects — but it also means key subprojects depend on a single person who is already load-bearing in the main repos. The pattern is worth noting as a concentration risk.

Data note: Event counts for subprojects are lower than liboqs/oqs-provider partly because discussion threads were not collected for this appendix (GraphQL is not available in this session). Engagement counts may therefore understate activity by 5–15% for repos with active GitHub Discussions.